Assignment – Module 2: Animated Storytelling Challenge

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Objective

Apply plot development, pacing, and subplot techniques to create a short-animated story.

Instructions

Create a short-animated story consisting of three scenes.

Your story must include:

Story Title

Character Description

Main Plot Summary

Subplot Summary

Three-Scene Story Outline

Scene 1 – Beginning

(Setup)

Scene 2 – Conflict

(Challenge)

Scene 3 – Resolution

(Outcome)

Optional Bonus

Include simple storyboard sketches for each scene.

Story Title: “Messages Left Behind”

Character Description

Mira, a 22-year-old woman, is emotionally closed off and distant after the death of her father. She believes he was absent and uncaring throughout her life. She avoids memories of him and struggles with unresolved anger.

Main Plot Summary

After her father's death, Mira receives a series of **pre-recorded voice messages** that unlock at different stages of her life. Each message reveals hidden truths about his sacrifices, forcing her to question everything she believed about him and decide whether she can forgive him.

Subplot Summary

Mira is also trying to restore an old **broken music box** her father gave her as a child.

- She thinks it is just a meaningless gift.
- She attempts to fix it out of curiosity, not emotion.
- Over time, she discovers it contains a hidden recording mechanism linked to the voice messages.

Connection: The music box is the original device used by her father to store and trigger the voice messages.

Scene 1 – Beginning (Setup)

Introduce:

- Main character
- Story world
- Character's goal

Scene 1 – Beginning (Setup)

Main Character:

Mira, a 22-year-old woman, is grieving the death of her father. She is emotionally distant, quiet, and filled with unresolved anger toward him, believing he was absent in her life.

Story World:

A quiet modern apartment filled with silence, memories, and emotional emptiness after her father's death.

What happens:

- Mira returns home after her father's funeral.
- She sits alone in the empty apartment, avoiding memories.
- She receives a digital voice message titled: "Open when you feel lost."
- Her father's voice plays, saying this is the first of several messages meant for her future.

Mira feels uncomfortable and angry, believing the messages are meaningless and too late to matter.

Character's Goal:

Mira decides she will ignore the messages, but secretly keeps them stored as curiosity begins to grow.

Subplot Begins:

While going through her father's belongings, she finds an old broken music box.
She starts trying to fix it mechanically, without understanding its emotional meaning.

Scene 2 – Conflict (Challenge)

Introduce a challenge, obstacle, or problem that prevents the character from achieving their goal.

Scene 2 – Conflict (Challenge)

Main Conflict:

- More voice messages unlock over time, revealing:
    - Her father secretly lost his job years ago.
    - He worked multiple hidden jobs to support her.
    - He was never absent by choice, but by sacrifice.
- Mira becomes emotionally conflicted, anger vs curiosity.

Cause & Effect:

- Each message increases emotional pressure → Mira isolates herself further.
- Her resentment grows because she feels her life was built on lies.
- She tries to delete the messages but cannot bring herself to do it.

Subplot Development:

- While fixing the music box, it briefly plays distorted audio.
- She realizes it is not just a toy, it has recorded sound fragments.
- She starts suspecting it is connected to the voice messages.

Scene 3 – Resolution

Show how the character overcomes the challenge (or fails to do so) and conclude the story.

Scene 3 – Resolution (Outcome)

Climax:

- The final voice message plays automatically when Mira completes the music box repair.
- Her father reveals the truth:
    - He knew he would die early.
    - He recorded messages so she would never feel abandoned.
    - He left the music box as a hidden emotional anchor.

Cause & Effect Resolution:

- The repaired music box unlocks the final hidden message layer.
- Mira hears her father's final words directly connected through the device.

Emotional Resolution:

- Mira breaks down emotionally.
- She finally understands his love was silent but constant.
- She chooses forgiveness, letting go of her resentment.

Subplot Resolution:

- The music box fully plays a soft melody with her father's voice embedded in it.
- It becomes her emotional keepsake, symbolizing reconciliation.

Conclusion:

> Mira keeps the music box as a reminder of her father's love and moves forward with peace, finally letting go of her resentment.

Additional Requirement: Subplot

Create one subplot that supports the main story.

The subplot should:

- Reveal something about the character
- Add emotional depth
- Support or complicate the main goal
- Connect naturally to the ending

Main Plot:

After her father's death, Mira receives a series of voice messages that reveal his hidden sacrifices. As she listens, she struggles with anger and confusion, believing he was distant. The messages force her to confront the truth and decide whether to forgive him or hold onto resentment.

Subplot:

Mira tries to repair an old broken music box left behind by her father. At first, she thinks it is just a simple object with no meaning, but she continues fixing it out of curiosity and emotion she does not fully understand.

How They Connect:

As Mira listens to the voice messages from her father, the music box begins to produce hidden sounds that match fragments of those messages. This makes her realize that the music box is somehow connected to her father's hidden truth, and it forces her to continue uncovering the messages instead of ignoring them.

Resolution:

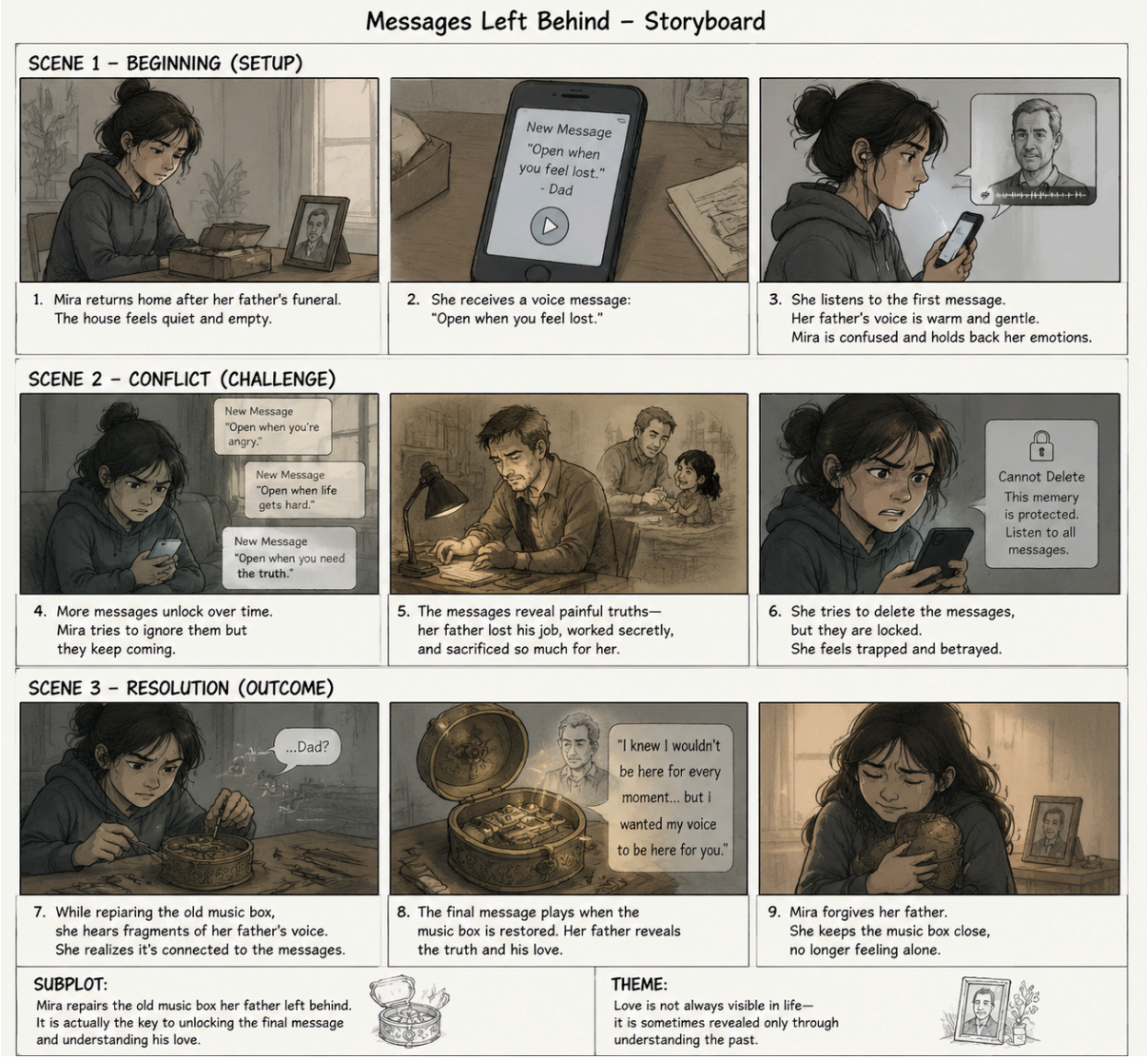
When Mira fully repairs the music box, it unlocks the final voice message from her father. This reveals his love and sacrifices, helping Mira understand the truth and finally forgive him.

Why This Works:

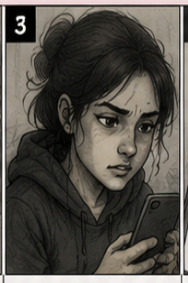
The main plot follows Mira receiving voice messages from her late father and struggling with emotional pain and confusion. The subplot of the music box shows her hidden emotional connection to her father. It adds depth, creates curiosity, and directly helps reveal the final truth, which resolves the main conflict.

Storyboard sketches

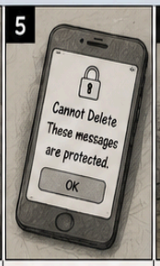
Include simple storyboard sketches for each scene.



SCENE 1 – BEGINNING (SETUP)

1	2	3	3	4	6
					
Mira returns home after her father's funeral, emotionally distant and broken.	She enters her silent home filled with memories she avoids.	She receives a mysterious voice message from her late father.	She feels confused and believes the message is meaningless.	Despite her anger, curiosity makes her keep the messages.	She discovers her father's old music box and begins to repair it.

SCENE 2 – CONFLICT (CHALLENGE)

1	5	3	4	5	6
					
More voice messages unlock over time.	The messages reveal her father secretly lost his job and worked multiple hidden jobs to support her.	She learns he was never absent by choice, but by sacrifice.	Mira becomes emotionally conflicted—anger vs curiosity.	She tries to delete the messages but cannot bring herself to do it.	While fixing the music box, it plays distorted audio. She realizes it has recorded sound fragments.

SCENE 3 – RESOLUTION (OUTCOME)

1	2	3	4	5	6
					
The final voice message plays automatically when Mira completes the music box repair.	Her father reveals the truth: he knew he would die early and left these messages for her.	Mira breaks down emotionally as everything finally makes sense.	She finally understands his love was silent but constant. She chooses forgiveness.	The music box fully plays a soft melody with her father's voice embedded in it.	It becomes her emotional keepsake, symbolizing reconciliation and unbreakable love.